

1635–1649

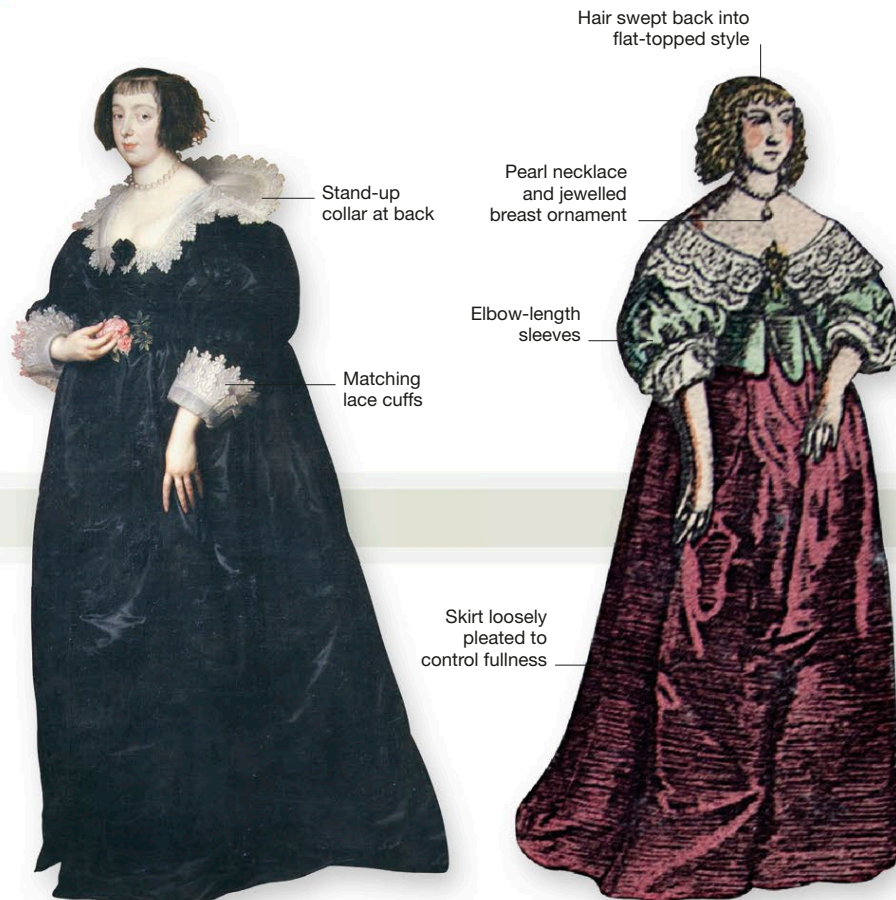
TAFFETA AND LACE

There was a relative simplicity about women's dress in the late 1630s and 1640s, with everyday styles consisting of a boned bodice and a separate skirt, usually made in soft, draping silks such as taffetas and satins. The look was completed with broad lace and linen collars, or folded kerchiefs worn across the shoulders or as edging to a bodice. Lace cuffs were attached to the sleeve ends of a linen smock that was worn as an undergarment. Hair was worn with the fringe set in thin curls across the forehead, with longer frizzed locks at the side. Henrietta Maria, the queen consort of King Charles I, both set the trends in fashions for women and attracted criticism for her extravagance from Puritan moralists.

COLLAR STARCHING

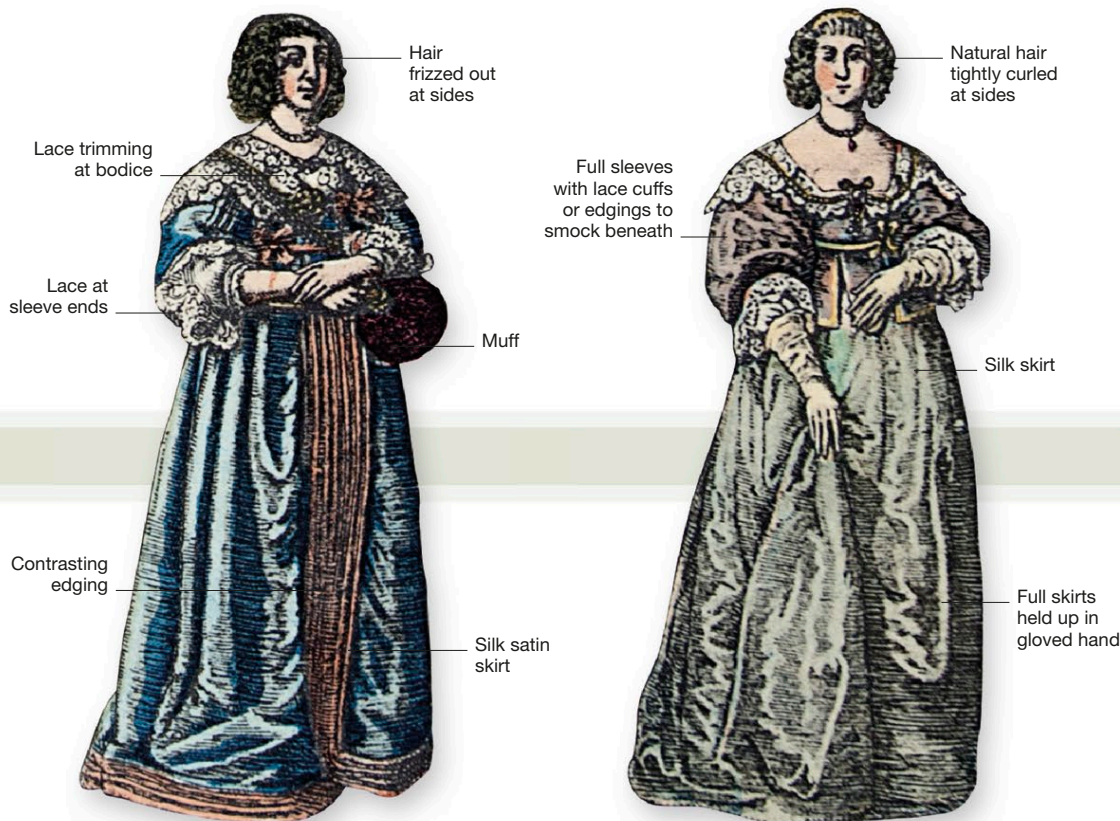


Fine white linen, deep lace collars, and pleated ruffs meant that skilled laundresses had an important role to play in mid-17th-century fashion, when cleanliness was a luxury. *Gerard's Herbal*, a popular almanac of the time, maintained that the purest and whitest starch was from the roots of the cuckoo pint plant but that it could chap and blister laundresses' hands.



Black clothes Dark clothing was fashionable in the Dutch United Provinces (the Netherlands). Large ruffs made of layers of linen, expertly laundered and pressed, remained in vogue here long after they died out in the rest of Europe.

High waist By the end of the 1630s women's dress throughout Europe was high-waisted. Here, the green silk separate boned bodice has deep tabs, the middle one a curved pointed shape, and is worn over a ruby-red silk skirt.



Lace collar New, softer fashions and glossy silks led to a spectacular rise in the production and consumption of lace. Excellent design skills and sharp business acumen meant that Flemish laces were popular across Europe.

Engravings The engraver Wenceslas Hollar was born in Bohemia and worked in London, copying portraits of aristocratic sitters so that the images could be widely sold as prints. This print shows a lady in a boned bodice, worn over a silk skirt.